

Multi – level Linked List
–Destroy List(Main List and Child)
–Program Analysis

Program:

```
void destroyNodeRecursively(Node *node)
{
    if (node == nullptr)
        return;

    // 1. Destroy Child List first
    destroyNodeRecursively(node->child);

    // 2. Destroy Next List
    destroyNodeRecursively(node->next);

    // 3. Free current
    cout << "Freeing node: " << node->data << endl;
    free(node);
}

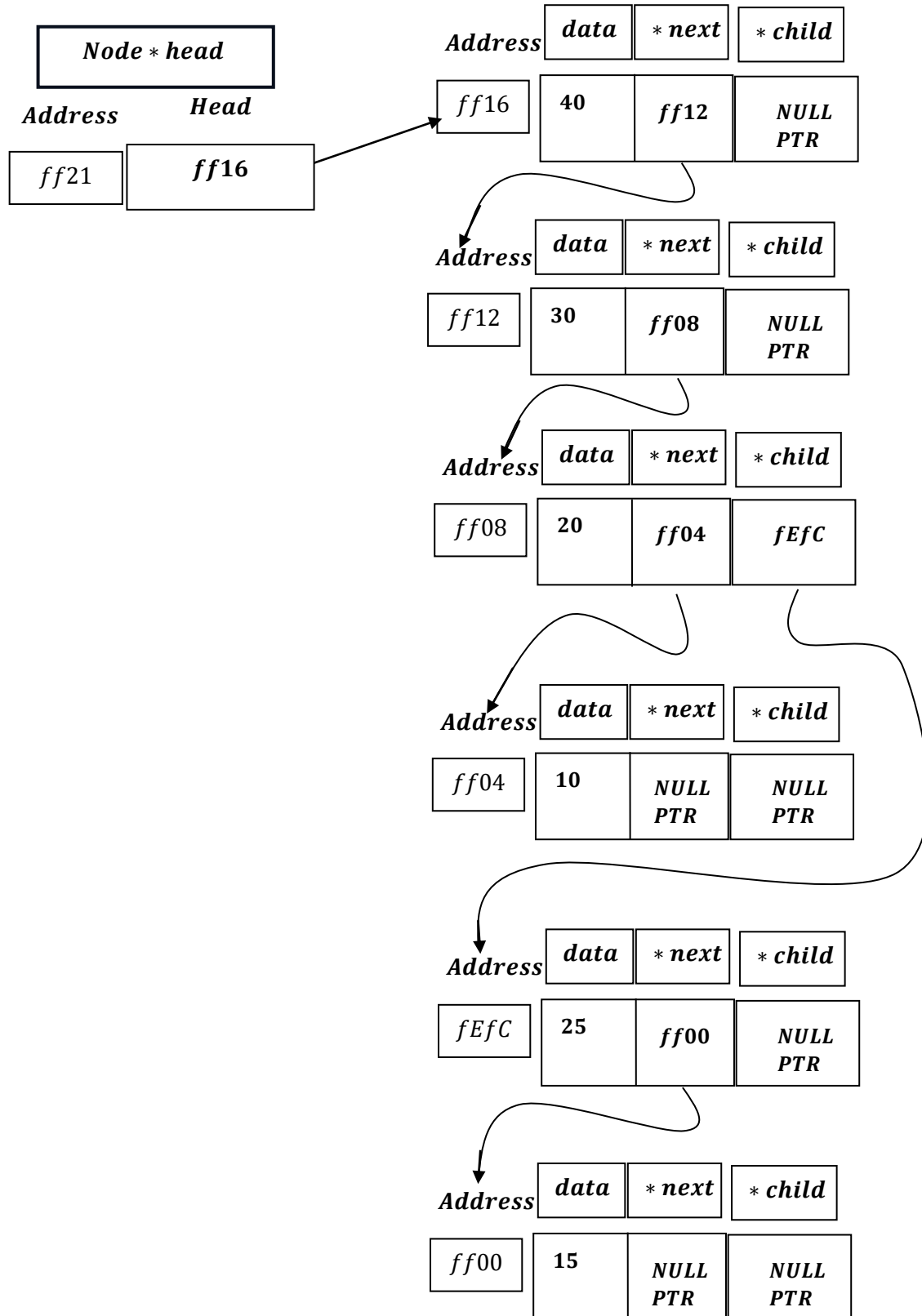
void destroyList()
{
    destroyNodeRecursively(head);
    head = nullptr;
    cout << "Entire list destroyed." << endl;
}

int main()
{
    int choice;
    while (true)
    {
        cout << "\n--- Multilevel List Menu ---" << endl;
        cout << "8. Destroy List" << endl;
        cin >> choice;

        switch (choice)
```

```
    {  
    case 8:  
        destroyList();  
        break;  
    default:  
        cout << "Invalid choice" << endl;  
    }  
}  
return 0;  
}
```

Program Analysis



As, it is, recursion:

Base Case:

```
if (node == nullptr)
    return;
```

As soon as destroy list function is called:

```
case 8:
    destroyList();
    break;
```

```
void destroyList()
{
    destroyNodeRecursively(head);
    head = nullptr;
    cout << "Entire list destroyed." << endl;
}
```

*Then inside destroyList function ,
destroyNodeRecursively(head: ff16) , is called.*

destroyNodeRecursively(head: ff16)

destroyList()

```
void destroyNodeRecursively(Node *node)
```

*Here Node * node = Head = ff16.*

```
if (node == nullptr)
    return;
```

Node $\neq$ nullptr, hence skips.

```
destroyNodeRecursively(node->child);
```

ff16 $\rightarrow$ child = NULLPTR.

$\rightarrow$ PUSH NULLPTR to the STACK.

<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff16 $\rightarrow$ Child := NULLPTR) $\rightarrow$ Stack Frame</i>
--

<i>destroyNodeRecursively(head: ff16) $\rightarrow$ Stack Frame</i>
--

Now, it will assign, as it call recursively :

*destroyNodeRecursively(Node * node) =*

destroyNodeRecursively(node $\rightarrow$ child: NULLPTR)

*i.e. Node * node = node $\rightarrow$ child: NULLPTR*

And, it is the base case:

```
if (node == nullptr)
    return;
```

As it goes to base case, return ; hence pop the current stack frame for nullptr pop up immediately .

<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff16 $\rightarrow$ Child: NULLPTR) $\rightarrow$ Stack Frame</i>
--

<i>destroyNodeRecursively(head: ff16) $\rightarrow$ Stack Frame</i>
--

POPPED

And, it will exit the current function call.

*destroyNodeRecursively(Node * node: NULLPTR)*

doesn't exit from the function[As, it is recursive]

```
destroyNodeRecursively(node->next);  
destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff16 → next: ff12)  
→ PUSH ff12 to the stack.
```

<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff16 → NEXT := ff12) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(head: ff16) → Stack Frame</i>

Now , it will assign, as it call recursively :

*destroyNodeRecursively(Node * node) =
destroyNodeRecursively(node → Next: ff12)*

And , now , node ≠ NULLPTR

Again, it will run InOrder:

```
destroyNodeRecursively(node->child);  
destroyNodeRecursively(node → child)  
⇒ destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff12 → child: NULLPTR)  
→ PUSH NULLPTR to the STACK.
```

<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff12 → child := NULLPTR) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff16 → NEXT := ff12) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(head := ff16) → Stack Frame</i>

Now , it will assign, as it call recursively :

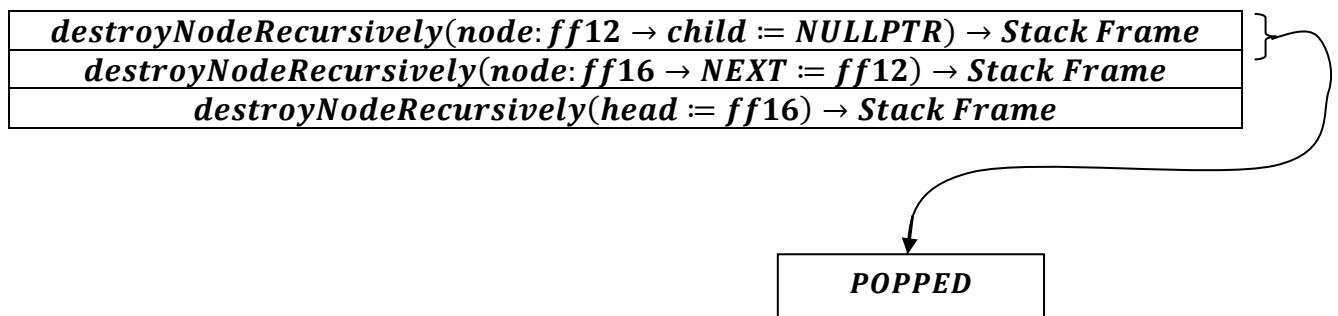
*destroyNodeRecursively(Node * node) =
destroyNodeRecursively(node → child: NULLPTR)*

*i. e. $Node * node = node \rightarrow child: NULLPTR$*

And, it is the base case:

```
if (node == nullptr)
    return;
```

As it goes to base case, return; hence pop the current stack frame for nullptr pop up immediately.



And, it will exit the current function call.

*destroyNodeRecursively(Node * node: NULLPTR)*

doesn't exit from the function[As, it is recursive].

```
destroyNodeRecursively(node->next);
```

destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff12 $\rightarrow$ next: ff08)

$\rightarrow$ PUSH ff08 to the STACK.

<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff12 $\rightarrow$ Next := ff08) $\rightarrow$ Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff16 $\rightarrow$ NEXT := ff12) $\rightarrow$ Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(head := ff16) $\rightarrow$ Stack Frame</i>

Now, it will assign, as it call recursively :

*destroyNodeRecursively(Node * node) =*

destroyNodeRecursively(node $\rightarrow$ Next: ff08)

And , now , node $\neq$ NULLPTR

Again, it will run InOrder:

```
destroyNodeRecursively(node->child);  
destroyNodeRecursively(node  $\rightarrow$  child)  
 $\Rightarrow$  destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff08  $\rightarrow$  child: fEfC)  
 $\rightarrow$  PUSH fEfC to the STACK.
```

<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff08 $\rightarrow$ Child := fEfC) $\rightarrow$ Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff12 $\rightarrow$ Next := ff08) $\rightarrow$ Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff16 $\rightarrow$ NEXT := ff12) $\rightarrow$ Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(head := ff16) $\rightarrow$ Stack Frame</i>

*destroyNodeRecursively(Node * node) =
destroyNodeRecursively(node $\rightarrow$ child: fEfC)*

And , now , node $\neq$ NULLPTR

Again, it will run InOrder $\left[\begin{array}{l} \text{here , node } \rightarrow \text{ child recursively called} \\ \text{again, as base case is not reached.} \end{array} \right]$:

```
destroyNodeRecursively(node->child);
```

*if node $\rightarrow$ child $\neq$ NULLPTR,
destroyNodeRecursively(node $\rightarrow$ child) keeps calling
recursively until the base case : node = NULLPTR is met.*

```
destroyNodeRecursively(node->child);  
destroyNodeRecursively(node  $\rightarrow$  child)
```


⇒ *destroyNodeRecursively(node: fEfC → child: NULLPTR)*
 → *PUSH NULLPTR to the STACK.*

<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: fEfC → Child := NULLPTR) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff08 → Child := fEfC) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff12 → Next := ff08) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff16 → NEXT := ff12) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(head := ff16) → Stack Frame</i>

Now , it will assign, as it call recursively :

*destroyNodeRecursively(Node * node) =*
destroyNodeRecursively(node → child: NULLPTR)

i. e. *Node * node = node → child: NULLPTR*

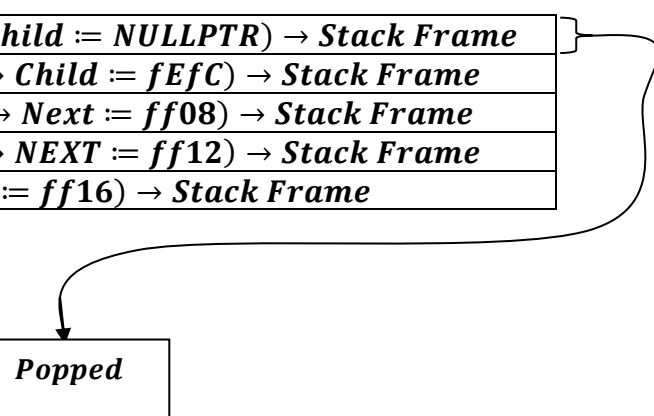
And, it is the base case:

```
if (node == nullptr)
    return;
```

As it goes to base case , return ; hence pop the current stack frame for nullptr pop up immediately .

<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: fEfC → Child := NULLPTR) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff08 → Child := fEfC) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff12 → Next := ff08) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff16 → NEXT := ff12) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(head := ff16) → Stack Frame</i>

Popped



And, it will exit the current function call.

*destroyNodeRecursively(Node * node: NULLPTR)*
 doesn't exit from the function[As, it is recursive].

```
destroyNodeRecursively(node->next);
```

destroyNodeRecursively(node: fEfC → next: ff00)

→ *PUSH ff00 to the STACK.*

<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: fEfC → NEXT := ff00) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff08 → Child := fEfC) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff12 → Next := ff08) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff16 → NEXT := ff12) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(head := ff16) → Stack Frame</i>

Again, it will run InOrder:

```
destroyNodeRecursively(node->child);
```

destroyNodeRecursively(node → child)

⇒ *destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff00 → child: NULLPTR)*

→ *PUSH NULLPTR to the STACK.*

<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff00 → Child := NULLPTR) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: fEfC → NEXT := ff00) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff08 → Child := fEfC) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff12 → Next := ff08) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff16 → NEXT := ff12) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(head := ff16) → Stack Frame</i>

Now , it will assign, as it call recursively :

*destroyNodeRecursively(Node * node) =*

destroyNodeRecursively(node → child: NULLPTR)

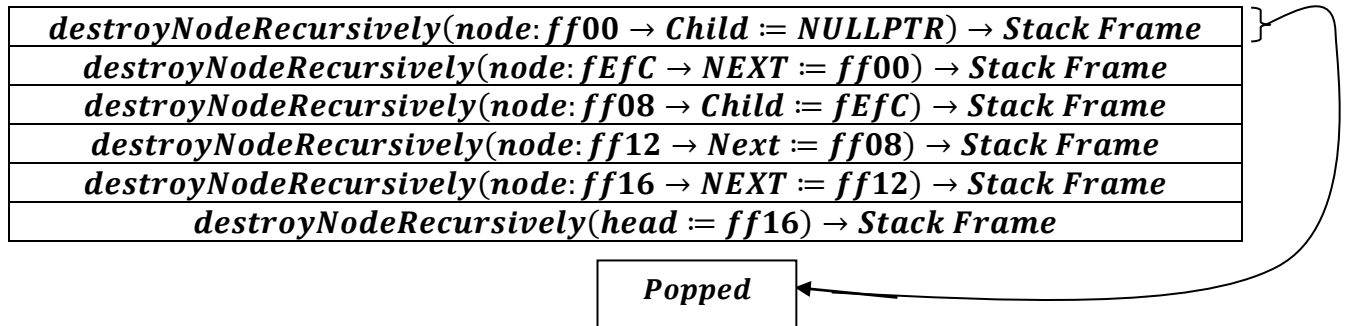
*i. e. Node * node = node → child: NULLPTR*

And, it is the base case:

```
if (node == nullptr)
    return;
```

As it goes to base case , return ; hence pop the current stack

frame for nullptr pop up immediately .



And, it will exit the current function call.

*destroyNodeRecursively(Node * node: NULLPTR)*

doesn't exit from the function[As, it is recursive].

```
destroyNodeRecursively(node->next);
```

destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff00 → NEXT: NULLPTR)

→ PUSH NULLPTR to the STACK.

<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff00 → NEXT := NULLPTR) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: fEfC → NEXT := ff00) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff08 → Child := fEfC) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff12 → Next := ff08) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff16 → NEXT := ff12) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(head := ff16) → Stack Frame</i>

Now , it will assign, as it call recursively :

*destroyNodeRecursively(Node * node) =*

destroyNodeRecursively(node → child: NULLPTR)

*i. e. Node * node = node → child: NULLPTR*

And, it is the base case:

```
if (node == nullptr)
    return;
```

As it goes to base case ,return ; hence pop the current stack frame for nullptr pop up immediately .

<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff00 → NEXT := NULLPTR) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: fEfC → NEXT := ff00) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff08 → Child := fEfC) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff12 → Next := ff08) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff16 → NEXT := ff12) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(head := ff16) → Stack Frame</i>

POPPED

So both recursive calls return immediately $\left[\begin{array}{l} \text{Base Case Met} \\ \text{for both the calls} \\ \text{i.e. NULLPTR} \end{array} \right]$.

```
// 1. Destroy Child List first
destroyNodeRecursively(node->child);

// 2. Destroy Next List
destroyNodeRecursively(node->next);
```

This is the time ,when the deeper recursive calls finish ,Now it ready for unwinding.

<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: fEfC → NEXT := ff00) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff08 → Child := fEfC) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff12 → Next := ff08) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff16 → NEXT := ff12) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(head := ff16) → Stack Frame</i>

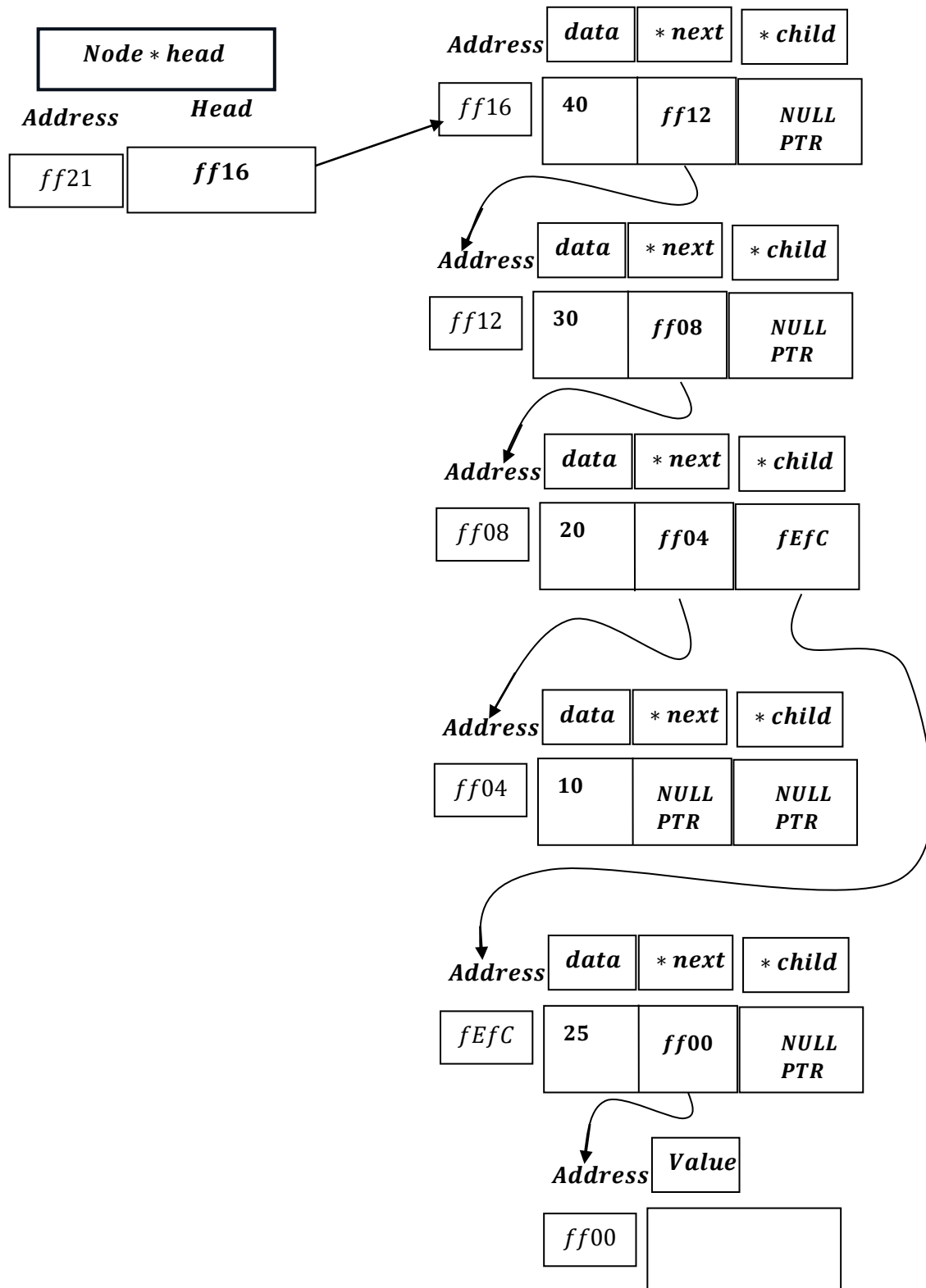
Popped

And it will run:

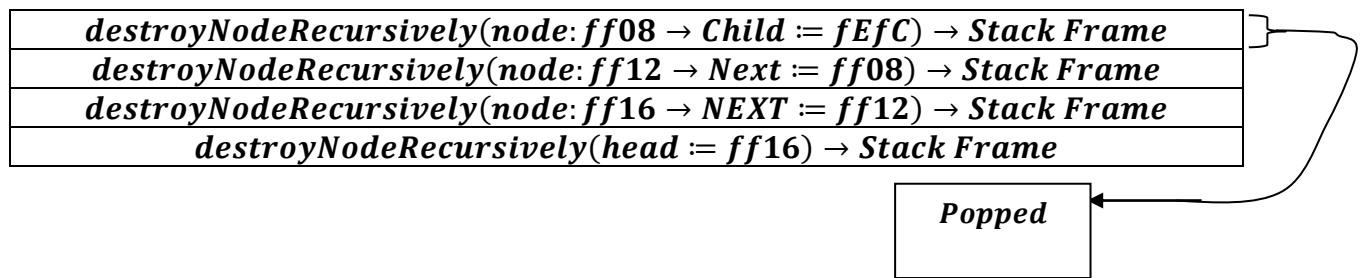
```
cout << "Freeing node: " << node->data << endl;
free(node);
```

Print : ``Freeing Node:`` [node: ff00 → data] = 15 .

Free(node: ff00)



Next:

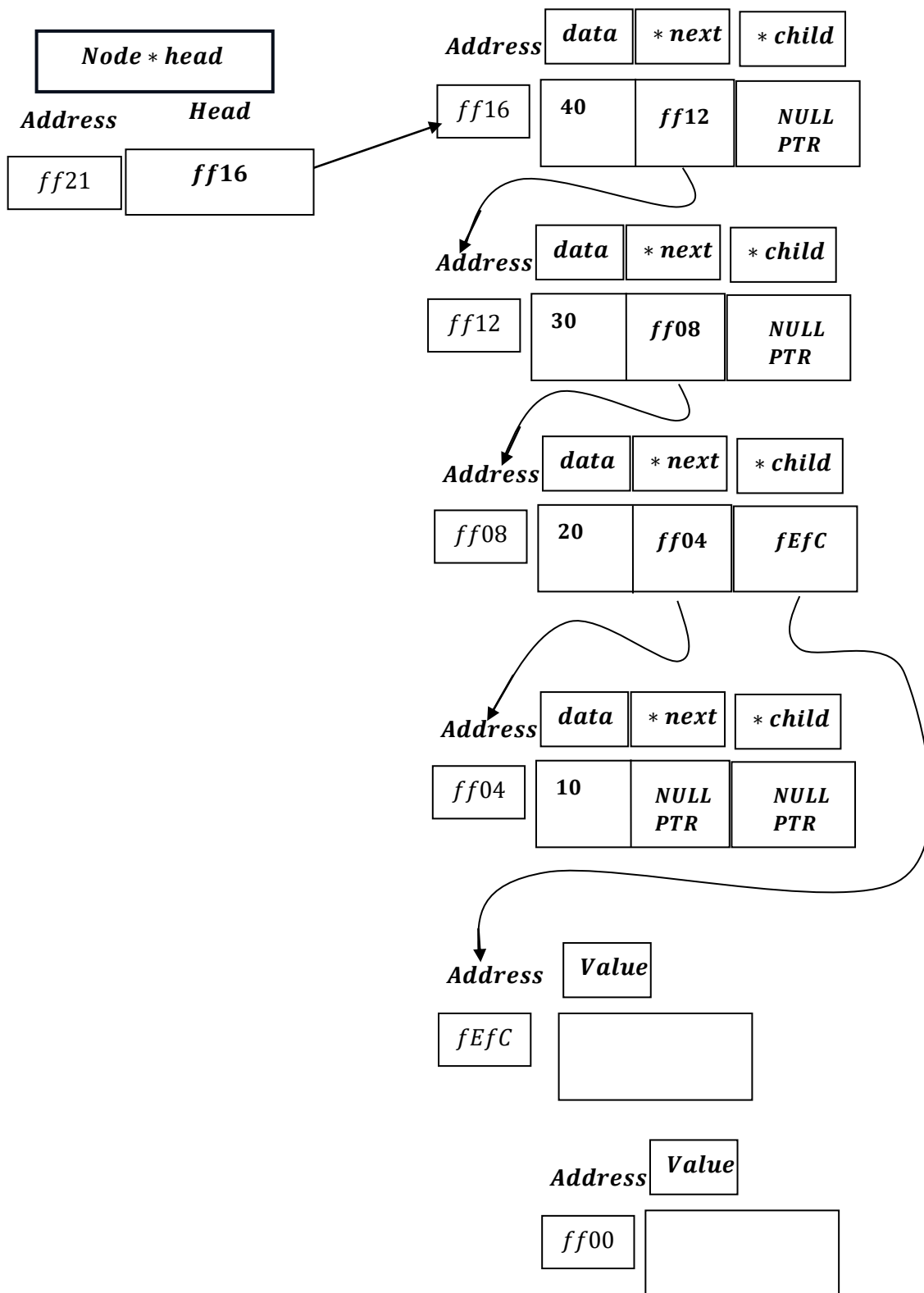


And it will run:

```
cout << "Freeing node: " << node->data << endl;  
free(node);
```

Print : ``Freeing Node:`` [node: fEfC → data] = 25 .

Free(node: fEfC)



Now we stand here:

<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff12 → Next := ff08) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff16 → NEXT := ff12) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(head := ff16) → Stack Frame</i>

Now it will backtrack to :

⇒ destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff08 → Next: ff04)

As, Compiler already created instruction for the program stored in code – segment part of the memory.

Now each recursive call stack creates a stack frame , consisting of :

- Return Address*
- Parameters*
- local variables*
- saved state.*

During Back Tracking :

- CPU pops return address from the stack.*
- Then load it to Program Counter(PC).*

Then its the work of Program Counter(PC):

→ It jumps back to the return address (say: 1005), The return address of the Code Segment of the Memory.

→ And, then it loads the instruction from the Code Segment from address(1005).

Here the instruction is to execute:

⇒ *destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff08 → Next: ff04)*

destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff08 → next: ff04)

→ *PUSH ff04 to the STACK.*

<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff08 → Next := ff04) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff12 → Next := ff08) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff16 → NEXT := ff12) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(head := ff16) → Stack Frame</i>

Now , it will assign, as it call recursively :

*destroyNodeRecursively(Node * node) =*
destroyNodeRecursively(node → Next: ff04)

And , now , *node ≠ NULLPTR*

Again, it will run InOrder:

```
destroyNodeRecursively(node->child);
```

⇒ *destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff04 → child: NULLPTR)*

→ **PUSH NULLPTR to the STACK.**

<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff04 → Child := NULLPTR) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff08 → Next := ff04) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff12 → Next := ff08) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff16 → NEXT := ff12) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(head := ff16) → Stack Frame</i>

Now , it will assign, as it call recursively :

*destroyNodeRecursively(Node * node) =*

destroyNodeRecursively(node → child: NULLPTR)

*i.e. Node * node = node → child: NULLPTR*

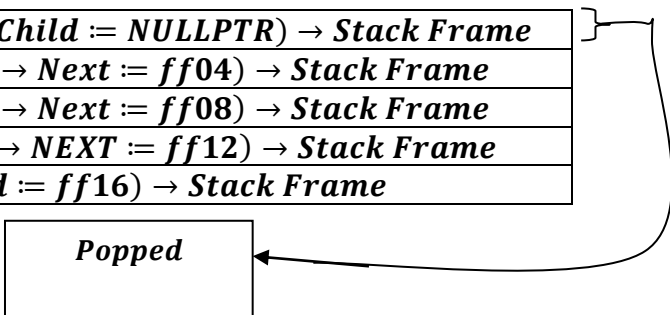
And, it is the base case:

```
if (node == nullptr)
    return;
```

As it goes to base case , return ; hence pop the current stack frame for nullptr pop up immediately .

<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff04 → Child := NULLPTR) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff08 → Next := ff04) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff12 → Next := ff08) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff16 → NEXT := ff12) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(head := ff16) → Stack Frame</i>

Popped



And, it will exit the current function call.

*destroyNodeRecursively(Node * node: NULLPTR)*

doesn't exit from the function[As, it is recursive].

```
destroyNodeRecursively(node->next);
```

destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff04 → Next: NULLPTR)

→ *PUSH NULLPTR to the STACK.*

<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff04 → Next := NULLPTR) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff08 → Next := ff04) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff12 → Next := ff08) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff16 → NEXT := ff12) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(head := ff16) → Stack Frame</i>

Now , it will assign, as it call recursively :

*destroyNodeRecursively(Node * node) =*

destroyNodeRecursively(node → child: NULLPTR)

*i. e. Node * node = node → child: NULLPTR*

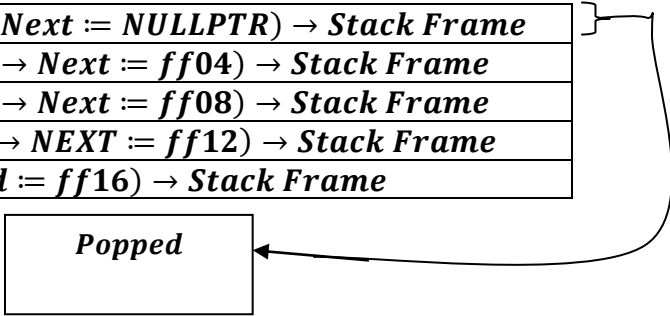
And, it is the base case:

```
if (node == nullptr)
    return;
```

As it goes to base case , return ; hence pop the current stack frame for nullptr pop up immediately .

<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff04 → Next := NULLPTR) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff08 → Next := ff04) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff12 → Next := ff08) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff16 → NEXT := ff12) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(head := ff16) → Stack Frame</i>

Popped

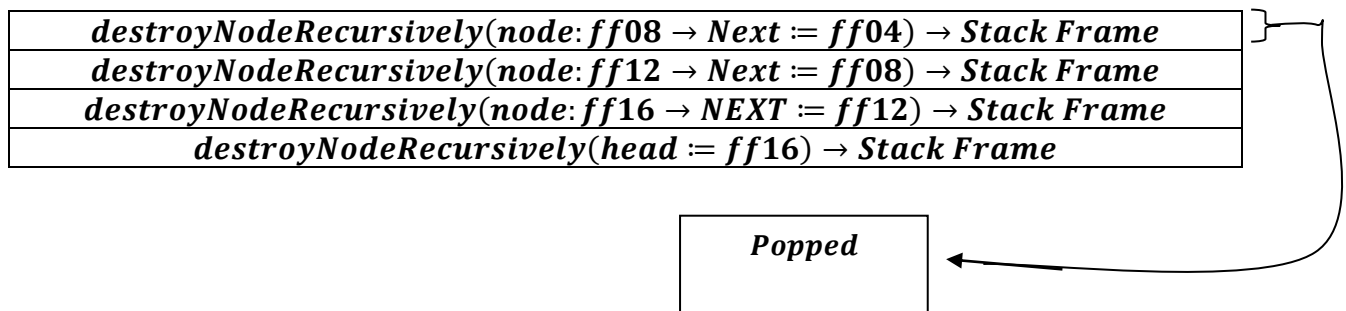


So both recursive calls return immediately $\left[\begin{array}{l} \text{Base Case Met} \\ \text{for both the calls} \\ \text{i.e. NULLPTR} \end{array} \right]$.

```
// 1. Destroy Child List first
destroyNodeRecursively(node->child);

// 2. Destroy Next List
destroyNodeRecursively(node->next);
```

This is the time ,when the deeper recursive calls finish ,Now it ready for unwinding.

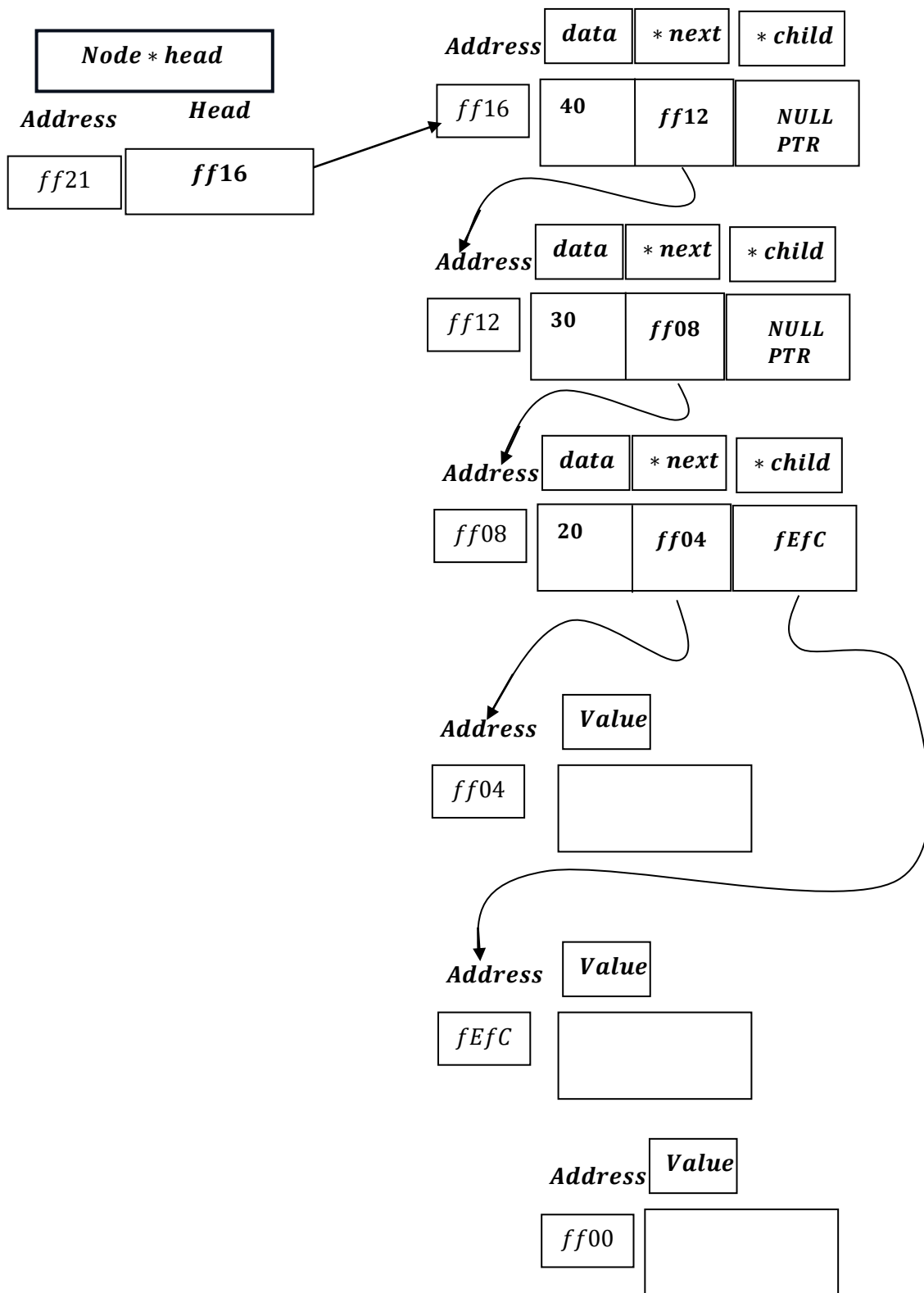


And it will run:

```
cout << "Freeing node: " << node->data << endl;
free(node);
```

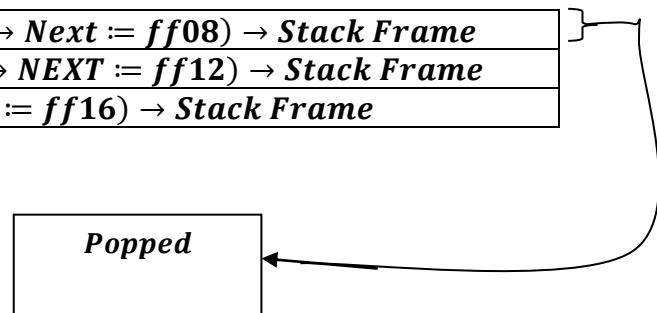
Print : ``Freeing Node:`` [node: ff04 → data] = 10 .

Free(node: ff04)



<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff12 → Next := ff08) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(node: ff16 → NEXT := ff12) → Stack Frame</i>
<i>destroyNodeRecursively(head := ff16) → Stack Frame</i>

Popped

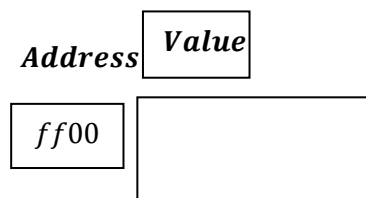
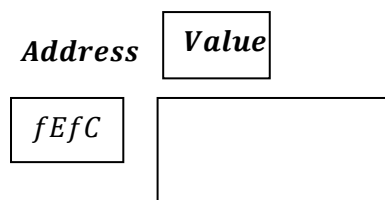
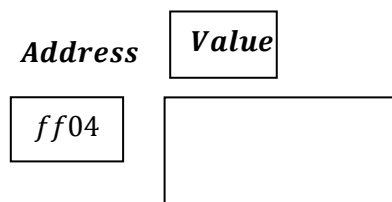
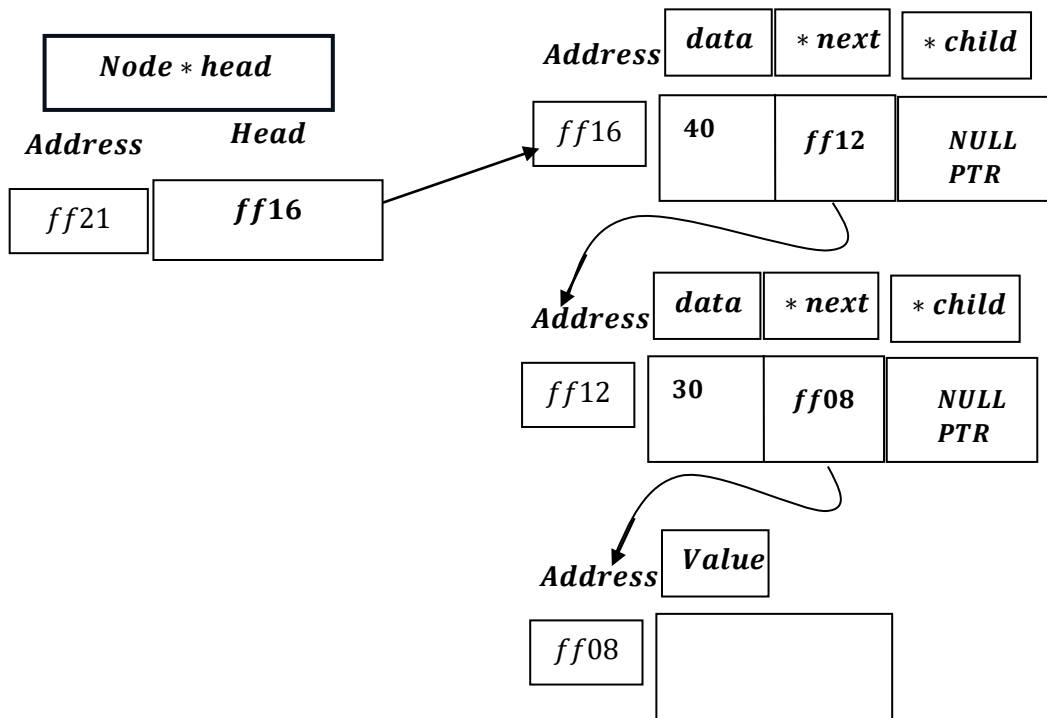


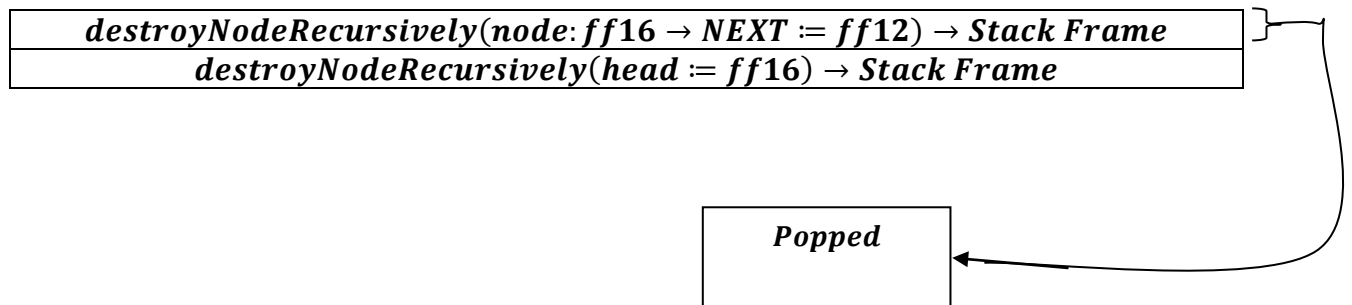
And it will run:

```
cout << "Freeing node: " << node->data << endl;  
free(node);
```

Print : ``Freeing Node:`` [node: ff08 → data] = 20 .

Free(node: ff08)



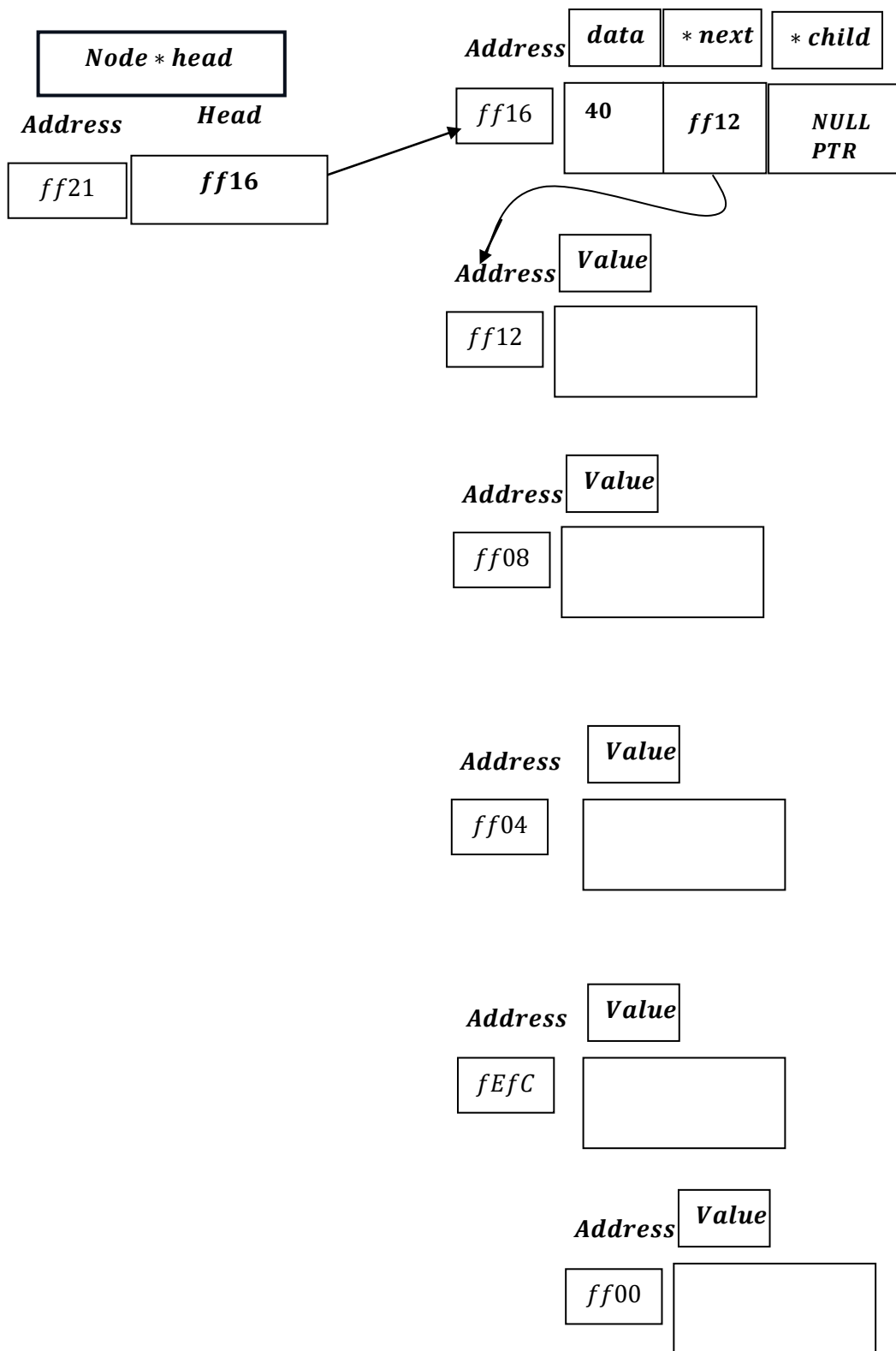


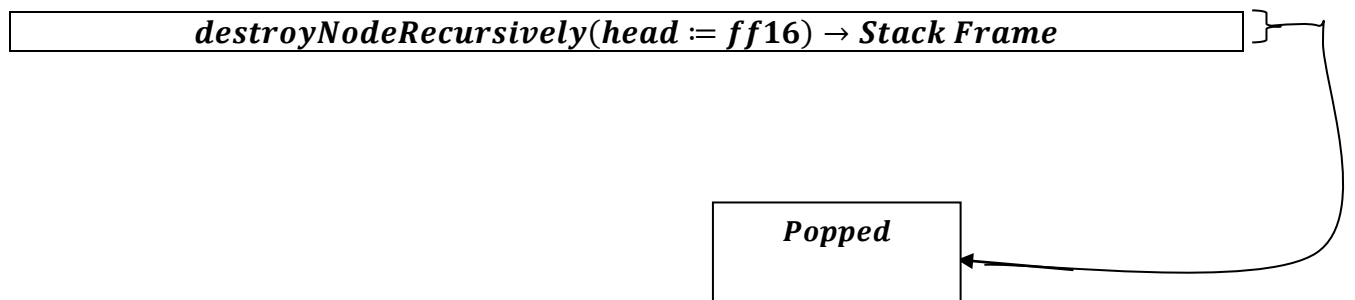
And it will run:

```
cout << "Freeing node: " << node->data << endl;  
free(node);
```

Print : ``Freeing Node:`` [node: ff12 $\rightarrow$ data] = 30 .

Free(node: ff12)



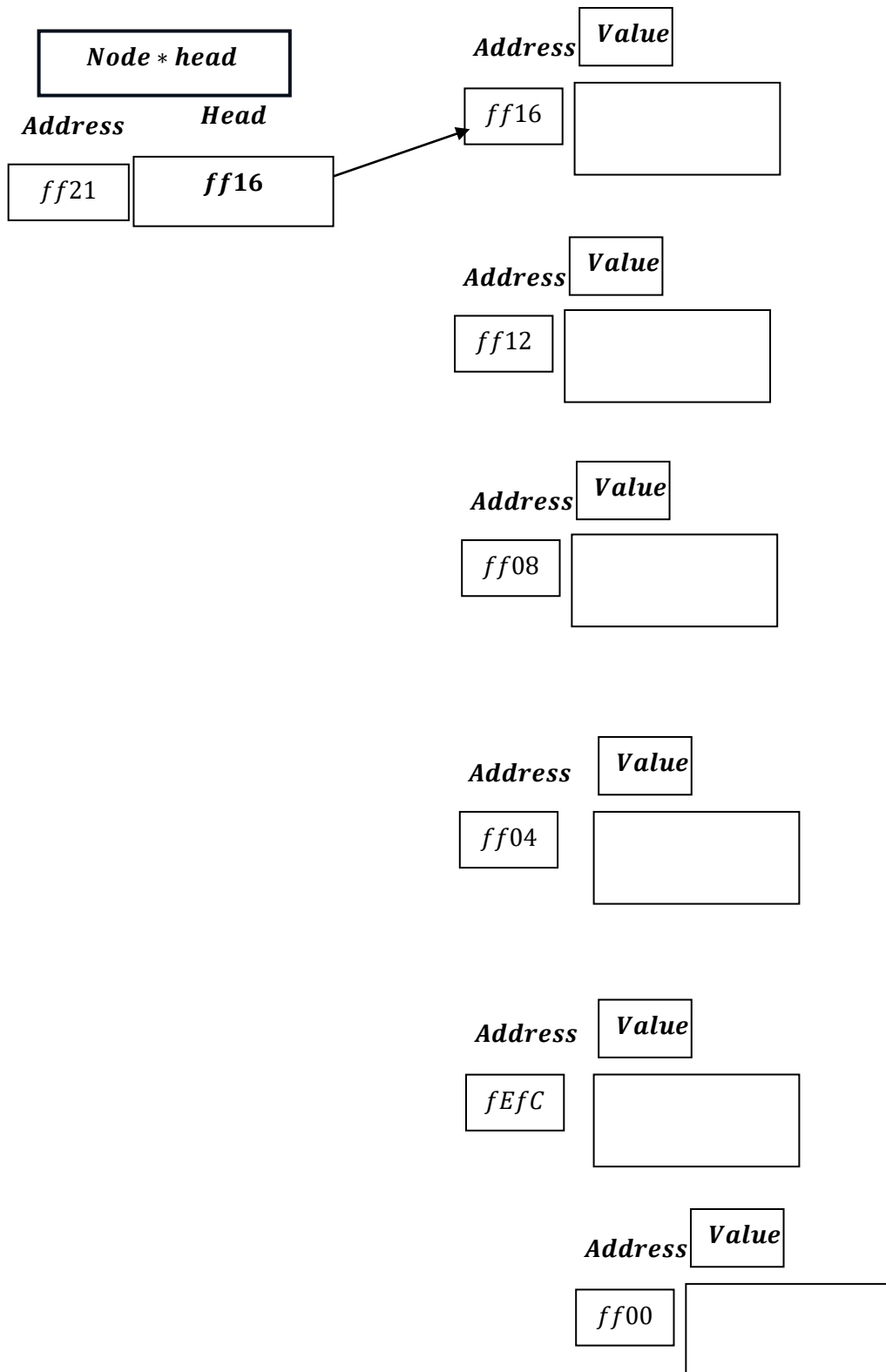


And it will run:

```
cout << "Freeing node: " << node->data << endl;  
free(node);
```

Print : ``Freeing Node:`` [node: ff16 → data] = 40 .

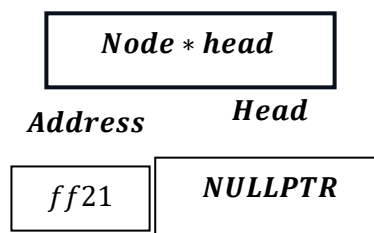
Free(node: ff16)



Now, coming back to :

```
void destroyList()
{
    destroyNodeRecursively(head);
    head = nullptr;
    cout << "Entire list destroyed." << endl;
}
```

Head = NULLPTR

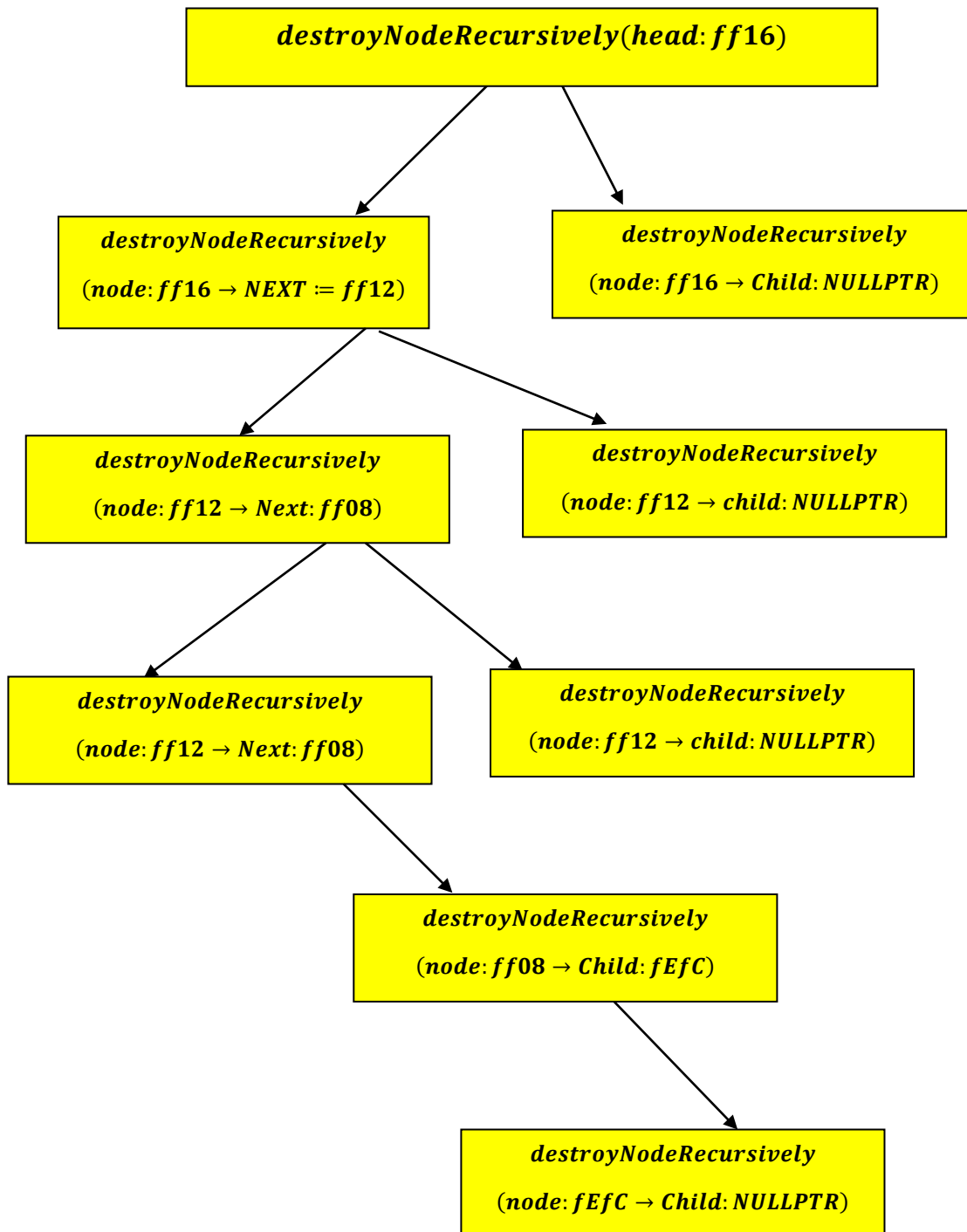


Now , list becomes empty.

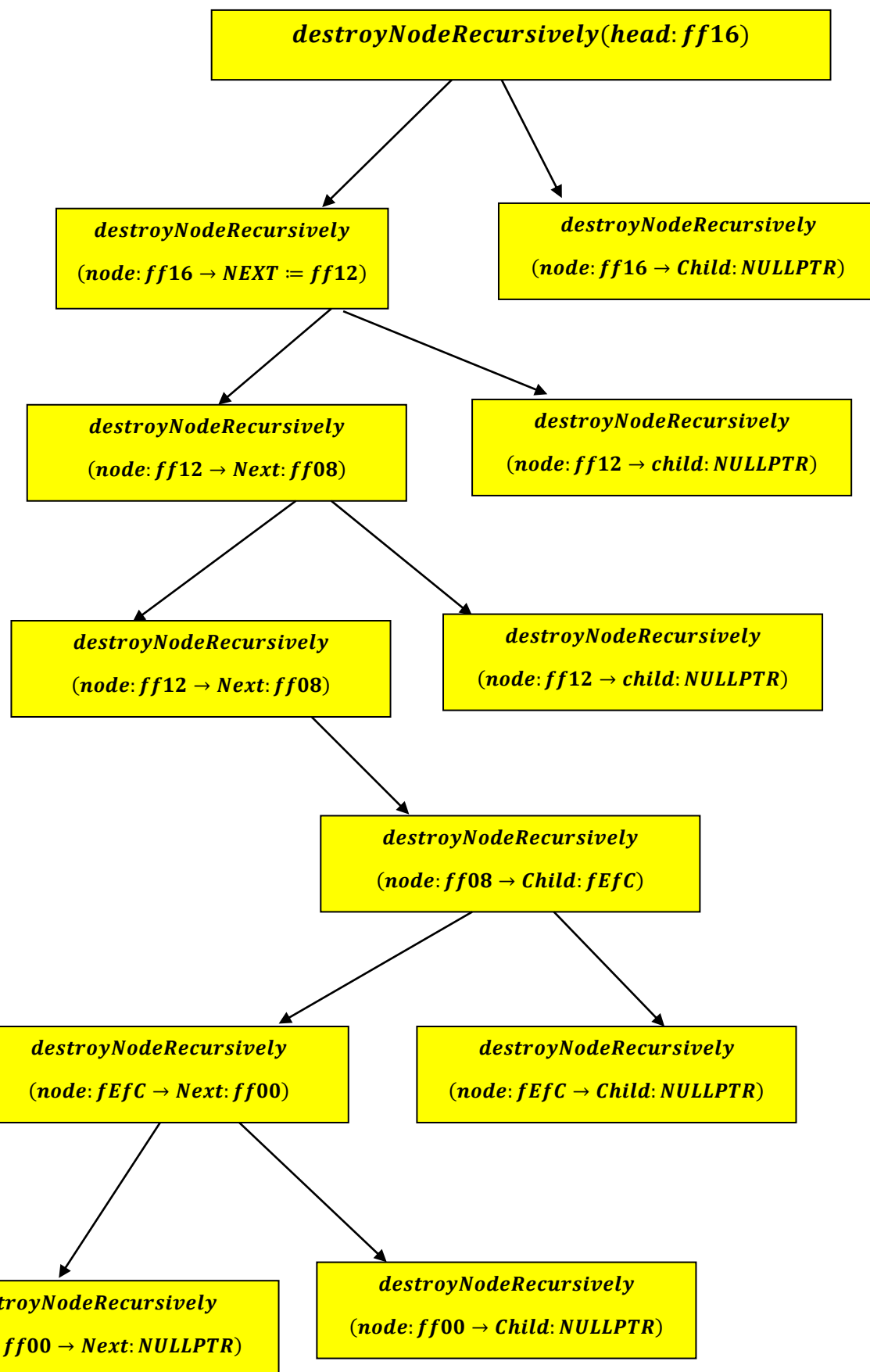
```
cout << "Entire list destroyed." << endl;
```

i. e. print ``Entire List destroyed.``

if we see the recursive tree then:



By Back Tracking again we get:



After unwinding and popping, it will again backtrack to:

